



<https://www.gettyimages.com/photos/jim-crow-laws>

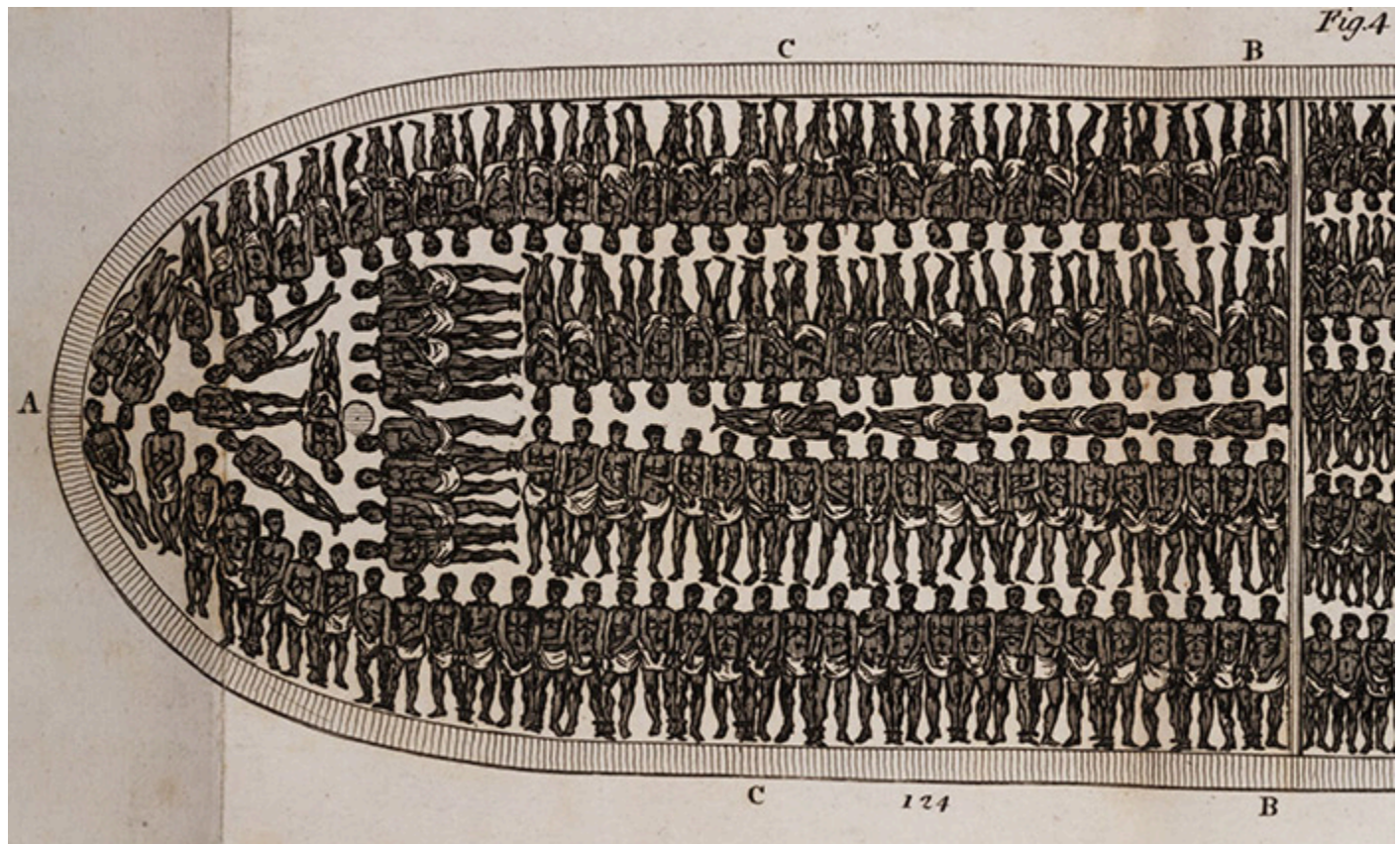
Caged Bird

By Maya Angelou

A free bird leaps
on the back of the wind
and floats downstream
till the current ends
and dips his wing
in the orange sun rays
and dares to claim the sky.

But a bird that stalks
down his narrow cage

can seldom see through
his bars of rage
his wings are clipped and
his feet are tied
so he opens his throat to sing.



The caged bird sings
with a fearful trill
of things unknown
but longed for still
and his tune is heard
on the distant hill
for the caged bird
sings of freedom.



The free bird **thinks of another breeze**
and the **trade winds** soft through the sighing trees
and **the fat worms** waiting on a dawn **bright lawn**
and he names the sky his own.

But a **caged bird stands on the grave of dreams**
his shadow shouts on a nightmare scream
his wings are clipped and his feet are tied
so he opens his throat to sing.

The caged bird sings
with a fearful trill
of things unknown
but longed for still
and his tune is heard
on the distant hill
for the caged bird
sings of freedom.



Figure: Material Significance for Palestinians

<https://www.twn.my/title2/resurgence/2016/310-311/poetry1.htm>

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OCmmK6oZdVY>

Identity card

Mahmoud Darwish

Put it on record.

I am an Arab

And the number of my card is fifty thousand

I have eight children

And the ninth is due after summer.

What's there to be angry about?

Put it on record.

I am an Arab~

Working with comrades of toil in a quarry.

I have eight children

For them I wrest the loaf of bread,

The clothes and exercise books

From the rocks

And beg for no alms at your door,

Lower not myself at your doorstep.

What's there to be angry about?

Put it on record.

I am an Arab.

I am a name without a title,

Patient in a country where everything

Lives in a whirlpool of anger.

My roots

Took hold before the birth of time

Before the burgeoning of the ages,

Before cypress and olive trees,

Before the proliferation of weeds.

My father is from the family of the plough

Not from highborn nobles.

And my grandfather was a peasant

Without line or genealogy.

My house is a watchman's hut

Made of sticks and reeds.

Does my status satisfy you?

I am a name without a surname.

Put it on record.

I am an Arab.

Colour of hair: jet black.

Colour of eyes: brown.

My distinguishing features:

On my head the `iqal cords over a keffiyeh

Scratching him who touches it.

My address:

I'm from a village, remote, forgotten,

Its streets without name

And all its men in the fields and quarry.

What's there to be angry about?

Put it on record.

I am an Arab.

You stole my forefathers' vineyards

And land I used to till,

I and all my children,

And you left us and all my grandchildren

Nothing but these rocks.

Will your government be taking them too

As is being said?

So!

Put it on record at the top of page one:

I don't hate people,

I trespass on no one's property.

And yet, if I were to become hungry

I shall eat the flesh of my usurper.

Beware, beware of my hunger

And of my anger!

Translated by Denys Johnson-Davies